

Codex Session Audit Guide

A weekly 20-30 minute review for improving Codex prompts, context files, validation habits, and reasoning-level choices.

Weekly Setup

- Review 3-5 meaningful Codex sessions from the week.
- Pick sessions that had real work, not only quick questions.
- Collect the prompt, outcome, validation, corrections, and reusable artifacts created.
- Spend 20-30 minutes total and finish with one concrete improvement.

Scorecard

Score each category from 1 to 5. Use notes only where they reveal a repeatable pattern.

Category	Question	Score
Goal clarity	Was the desired outcome clear before Codex started?	1 2 3 4 5
Context quality	Did Codex get the right files, constraints, and background?	1 2 3 4 5
Reasoning fit	Was the mode low enough to be efficient but strong enough to pass validation?	1 2 3 4 5
Tool discipline	Did Codex inspect, edit, test, and verify in the right order?	1 2 3 4 5
Corrections	How many user corrections were needed? Lower is better.	1 2 3 4 5
Reuse	Did the session create or improve a reusable artifact?	1 2 3 4 5
Validation	Was done proven by a command, readback, screenshot, or manual check?	1 2 3 4 5

Evidence To Capture

- Task name and reasoning/profile level used.
- Files Codex inspected and files Codex changed.
- Validation command or manual check.
- Number of corrections.
- What wasted tokens.
- What should become a reusable prompt, checklist, template, or AGENTS.md rule.

Pattern Questions

- Where did Codex ask for context that could have been in a file?
- Where did Codex inspect too much or too little?
- Which prompts were longer than necessary?
- Which tasks should have used a lower reasoning mode?
- Which tasks should have escalated sooner?
- Which mistakes happened more than once?
- Which reusable artifact would prevent the same explanation next week?

Weekly Decision

Choose exactly one improvement. A small durable change beats a broad intention.

- Update AGENTS.md.
- Add or refine a prompt.
- Add or refine a checklist.
- Add or refine a template.
- Add a rule to the reasoning profile guide.
- Remove outdated context that made Codex slower.

Output Template

```
Week:  
Sessions reviewed:  
Average score:  
Best session:  
Most wasteful session:  
Main pattern:  
One improvement:  
File to update:  
Validation for next week:
```

Done When

- At least 3 sessions were reviewed.
- One repeated pattern was named.
- One artifact was created or improved.
- The next week has a specific validation check.

Recommended Weekly Rhythm

Audit on the same day each week. Keep the review short, choose one improvement, and let the next week prove whether it helped.